

Companies should continue to find ways to support the ecosystem as open source is driving great innovation throughout the industry



Raman Sharma, VP product marketing, DigitalOcean

The year 2020 will go down in history as perhaps the most challenging and traumatic of the 21st century. This year, the definition of ‘normal’ changed completely for everyone, and the open source community was no exception.

This community, which is known to work for important causes without expecting much in return, has had to make some hard choices in light of the global crisis. In its *Currents* report titled ‘Impact of 2020 on Open Source’, DigitalOcean focused on one such fundamental choice — should open source contributions be free?

OSFY talked to **Raman Sharma, VP product marketing, DigitalOcean**, on the *Currents* survey, the role of DigitalOcean in the open source space, and his thoughts on the growing open source ecosystem.

Q. What prompted you to do this interesting study?

We started *Currents*, our seasonal report, as a way to keep up with the technologies and tools that developers are most interested in and provide a way to help them achieve their goals. We also wanted to share our findings with the community. We decided to dedicate one of our annual reports entirely to open source because of how critical it is to both our work and our community.

Q. How did you conduct this survey covering 9000+ respondents?

The global survey was conducted in-house and was open to the entire community. We shared it with our networks to gather responses, but it was not limited to our customers.

Respondents who completed the full survey were eligible for a ‘Sammy’ sticker or could opt to have a tree planted on their behalf in the DigitalOcean forest.

Q. Why focus on the aspect of ‘getting paid’ for open source works?

The survey focuses on a few key areas:

- Participation trends in open source and the impact of the pandemic
- Inclusivity and ethics in open source
- The economics of open source

The question of whether or not individuals should be paid for open source contributions is one that we